

**QualiPharm Inc. — Global Quality**  
**STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE**  
**Global Complaint Classification Guide**

|                |                                                 |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| SOP Number     | SOP-QA-001                                      |
| Version        | 5.0                                             |
| Effective Date | February 01, 2024                               |
| Review Date    | February 01, 2026                               |
| Jurisdiction   | GLOBAL — Applies to all sites and jurisdictions |
| Document Owner | Global Quality Assurance                        |
| Approved By    | Chief Quality Officer                           |
| Classification | ACTIVE — Supersedes v4.2                        |

## 1. Purpose

This global SOP establishes a uniform complaint classification framework applicable to all QualiPharm manufacturing sites and distribution markets. It ensures that complaints are consistently classified by severity and routed to the correct jurisdiction-specific investigation procedure, in alignment with ICH Q10 (Pharmaceutical Quality System) and ICH Q9 (Quality Risk Management) principles.

## 2. Scope

This SOP applies globally to all QualiPharm sites, markets, and jurisdictions including:

- US markets regulated by FDA (21 CFR Part 211) — handled via SOP-QA-042
- EU/EEA markets regulated by EMA (EudraLex Volume 4) — handled via SOP-EU-GMP-001
- UK markets regulated by MHRA
- Canadian markets regulated by Health Canada

This document defines classification only. Investigation procedures are jurisdiction-specific.

## 3. Severity Definitions

| Risk Level      | Definition                                                                      | Criteria                                                                             | SLA — Human Review              |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>CRITICAL</b> | Patient harm confirmed or probable. Requires immediate regulatory notification. | Patient harm OR contamination in sterile product OR wrong product/strength dispensed | 4 hours from complaint receipt  |
| <b>HIGH</b>     | Contamination without patient harm. Recurrent defects. Sterility concerns.      | contamination + no patient impact OR recurrent quality defect in same product        | 24 hours from complaint receipt |

|               |                                                                                         |                                                                                     |                                  |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>MEDIUM</b> | Quality or labeling defect without patient impact. Standard regulatory non-compliance.  | quality or labeling complaint, no patient impact, no recurrence                     | 72 hours from complaint receipt  |
| <b>LOW</b>    | Minor cosmetic or subjective complaint. No safety, efficacy, or regulatory implication. | Appearance, taste/smell preference, minor packaging cosmetics — no defect confirmed | 168 hours from complaint receipt |

## 4. Jurisdiction Routing Rules

After classification, the complaint is routed to the jurisdiction team based on the market\_code field:

| market_code        | jurisdiction | Authority     | Investigation SOP                          |
|--------------------|--------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------|
| US                 | US           | FDA           | SOP-QA-042 — US Complaint Handling         |
| EU, DE, FR, IT, ES | EU           | EMA / NCA     | SOP-EU-GMP-001 — EU Complaint Handling     |
| UK                 | EU           | MHRA          | SOP-EU-GMP-001 — UK follow EU procedure    |
| CA                 | US           | Health Canada | SOP-QA-042 — aligned with FDA requirements |

## 5. Classification Escalation Rules

The following rules override the base classification and must be applied before final risk\_level assignment:

- **PATIENT IMPACT OVERRIDE:** If patient\_impact is true, minimum risk\_level is critical regardless of complaint\_type
- **RECURRENCE ESCALATION:** If a complaint of the same type on the same product occurred in the past 12 months, escalate risk\_level by one tier
- **STERILE PRODUCT RULE:** contamination + sterile\_injectable always = critical, regardless of patient\_impact value
- **MISSING BATCH RULE:** If batch\_number is null or unknown, set status = pending\_review. Do NOT classify as low risk pending resolution.
- **REGULATORY THRESHOLD:** Any issue meeting FDA Field Alert Report criteria (US) or EMA rapid alert criteria (EU) must be classified as critical minimum

## 6. Revision History

| Version | Date     | Author    | Summary                                                                                              |
|---------|----------|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 5.0     | Feb 2024 | Global QA | Added MISSING BATCH RULE and STERILE PRODUCT RULE to escalation section. Updated jurisdiction table. |

|     |          |           |                                                         |
|-----|----------|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 4.2 | Sep 2022 | Global QA | Revised SLA table to align with ICH Q10 CAPA timelines. |
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